



COURSE SYLLABUS

WR227 – Technical Writing

1. GENERAL INFORMATION

Course name: Technical Writing

Course name (in Vietnamese):

Course ID: WR227

Knowledge block:

Number of credits: 4

Credit hours for theory: 40

Credit hours for practice: 0

Credit hours for self-study: 60

Prerequisite: none

Instructors: Nguyen Van Vu

2. COURSE DESCRIPTION

The course is designed to provide students skills to write technical documents with particular emphasis on academic papers. The students are first introduced to the principles of readers analysis and the general process of composing a technical document, so that they are able to aware of the mission and importance of technical writing. Students then go through primary parts of an academic paper to recognize how to collect appropriate information and where to put these pieces of data while pursuing a coherent idea. Tips for good style and rules of writing ethically are also discussed. These skills ensure the standard quality for the paper that students write now and in the future. Students are required to diligently improve their technical writing abilities through a series of personal/group assignments.

3. COURSE GOALS

At the end of the course, students are able to

ID	Description	Program LOs
G1	Understand the basic elements of an academic papers and things that decide the quality of the paper	
G2	Employ supporting tools for writing text and demonstration effectively	
G3	Develop critical thinking and analytic skills to present the proposed ideas into an academic paper	
G4	Develop communication skills and group-work spirits	

4. COURSE OUTCOMES

CO	Description	I/T/U
G1.1	Identify your readers in certain research fields to select a good style for the paper	T/U
G1.2	Ethics in technical writing	I
G1.3	Collect, analyze, document, and report research clearly, concisely, logically, and ethically	T/U
G2.1	Compose academic papers on Latex and share them through Overleaf	I/U
G2.2	Employ diagrams, tables, charts, and other graphical tools effectively	I/U
G3.1	Differentiate among facts, making inferences and judgements in a sound and complete manner	T/U
G3.2	Assess the information and criticize the ideas/results from different perspectives	T/U
G4.1	Arrange your ideas systematically during communications (writing or speaking)	U
G4.2	Contribute considerate efforts in writing activities (individually and in collaboration) that help improving the quality of the paper	U

5. TEACHING PLAN

ID	Topic	Course outcomes	Teaching/Learning Activities (samples)
1	Class Introduction Common Technical Writing Issues	G1.1	Project assignment out
2	Tools for paper writing and publication LaTeX and Overleaf Tutorial		Project proposal
3	Paper writing process, structure, and general guidelines	G1.1, G2.1	
4	Paper Title and Abstract	G1.3	Writing Abstract
5	Paper Introduction	G1.3	Writing Introduction
6	Paper Background and Related Work	G1.2, G1.3	Writing Background and Related Work Individual homework: Paper review 1 out
7	Paper Method	G2.2	Writing Method
8	Experiment and Results	G3.1, G3.2	Writing Experiment and Results Individual homework: Paper review 1 due Individual homework: Paper review 2 out
9	Discussions	G4.2	Writing Discussions
10	Threats to Validity and Conclusion	G4.2	Individual homework: Paper review 2 due Paper first submission

11	Scientific Publication Process		
12	Writing a Graduation Thesis		
13	Paper Presentation	G4.1	Individual homework: Review 3 Paper final submission

There are likely exercises given in each class involving instructors reviewing, evaluating students' submissions, and students practicing analyzing and writing sections of papers.

6. ASSESSMENTS

ID	Topic	Description	Course outcomes	Contribution (%)
Hw	Homework	Students will perform paper reviews individually.	G3.2	15%
Ds	Discussion and Exercises	There will be group discussions and exercises in class.	G1.3, G2.2, G3.1, G4.1	20%
Pr	Paper presentation	Each group will have 10 minutes to present their proposal or full paper.	All	10%
PP	Paper	Each group of two students will write and submit a scientific paper on a topic of computer science. There will be 8 assignments for writing a paper, starting from proposal to final submission.	All	55%

7. RESOURCES

Textbook

- Justin Zobel. 2014. **Writing for Computer Science** (4th. ed.). Springer.

Others

- C. George Thomas, 2021. **Research Methodology and Scientific Writing** (2nd ed.), Springer.
- Simon Peyton Jones, Microsoft Research, Cambridge. **How to write a great research paper**.
- David Salesin, Adobe. 2012. **How to Write a SIGGRAPH Paper: A Guide to Choosing a Good Research Topic, Doing the Research, and Writing It Up**. SIGGRAPH Tutorial.
- Other materials and readings are posted on Moodle.

8. GENERAL REGULATIONS & POLICIES

Academic Integrity

Students are prohibited from plagiarism and cheating of any kind in this class. Some examples of plagiarism and cheating are copying someone else's work, giving your work to others, presenting someone else's ideas, discussing with others during an exam, copying text from sources without proper attribution, and using unauthorized materials. Such violations will result in serious consequences. Those who violates will receive zero for violating assignment/quiz/exam, and may be reported to the Faculty for further action.

Late Submission Policy

The students are encouraged to submit the assignments on time. But if the deadline is not met, 15% deduction on the assignment total grade is applied for each day late. The students will receive zero if submitting after the third day following the deadline. In exceptional and difficult cases such as illness, the students must obtain the permission for possible extensions from the instructor. In doing so, the students must present reasonable evidence along with the request.

Class Attendance and Material Preparation

- Students are required to attend all classes. According to the APCS program's attendance policy, **you have to attend at least 70% of class sessions to be eligible for taking the final exam**, which is the Presentation and Paper components in this CS305.
- My experience is that those attended classes regularly received higher grades than those who skipped the class often.



- Students are strongly encouraged to ask questions during lecture.
- Students are required to read all reading materials listed in the class schedule, desirably before each classroom lecture.